



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: August 7, 2026	Entry: 1
Description	Documented a ransomware security incident affecting a healthcare clinic. Analyzed the incident using the 5 W's method.
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	● Who caused the incident? An organized group of unethical hackers caused the incident by sending phishing emails with malicious attachments. ● What happened? Employees were unable to access medical records and other critical files because ransomware encrypted the organization's systems. A ransom note demanded payment for the decryption key. ● When did the incident occur? The incident occurred on a Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m. ● Where did the incident happen?

	• The incident occurred at a small U.S. healthcare clinic specializing in primary care services and affected its computer network and systems. • Why did the incident happen? • The attackers gained access through a phishing email containing a malicious attachment. After an employee downloaded it, ransomware was installed and encrypted the clinic's files.
Additional notes	This incident demonstrates the importance of security awareness training, email filtering, regular backups, and an incident response plan. Organizations should educate employees to recognize phishing attacks and maintain secure backup systems.

Date: August 2026	Entry: Network Traffic Investigation
Description	I investigated network traffic to identify suspicious activity and understand how packets move through a network. I reviewed packet information and analyzed network communication to identify potential security concerns. This activity was part of the Detection and Analysis phase of the NIST Incident Response Lifecycle.
Tool(s) used	

The 5 W's	• Who: A security analyst investigated the suspicious network activity. • What: Network traffic and packets were analyzed for potentially suspicious activity. • When: The investigation occurred after suspicious network activity was identified. • Where: The investigation focused on network traffic captured from a network interface. • Why: The goal was to determine whether the traffic indicated a potential security incident.
Additional notes	

Date: August 2026	Entry: Exploring Suricata
Description	I explored Suricata to understand how network-based threat detection works. I learned how Suricata uses signatures to identify patterns associated with potentially malicious network activity and how it generates event and alert data. This activity helped me understand how security analysts detect suspicious network traffic.
Tool(s) used	• Suricata: A network threat detection tool used to monitor network traffic and identify suspicious activity. • Signatures: Used to detect known patterns associated with potentially malicious activity. • EVE JSON: Used by Suricata to output event and alert information.

The 5 W's	
Additional notes	

Date: August 2026	Entry: Investigating Failed SSH Logins with Wazuh
Description	I used the Wazuh dashboard to search and analyze security event data from a mail server. I narrowed the search to failed SSH login attempts involving the root account. This activity helped me practice searching logs and identifying events that could indicate a possible security issue.
Tool(s) used	• Wazuh: Used to collect, search, and analyze security event data. • Search queries: Used to narrow a large amount of event data and locate relevant security events. • Logs: Reviewed to identify failed SSH authentication attempts.
The 5 W's	
Additional notes	

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.

1. Were there any specific activities that were challenging for you? Why or why not?

Some activities were challenging because I was still learning how cybersecurity tools and network data work. Working with logs, packets, and search queries required attention to detail, but practicing these activities helped me understand the concepts better.

2. Has your understanding of incident detection and response changed since taking this course?

Yes, my understanding of incident detection and response has changed significantly. I now understand that incident response includes several phases, such as Detection and Analysis, Containment, Eradication and Recovery, and Post-Incident Activity.

3. Was there a specific tool or concept that you enjoyed the most? Why?

I enjoyed learning about Wazuh and SIEM searches the most. It was interesting to see how security analysts can search through large amounts of log data to identify suspicious events and investigate potential security incidents.